Andaz Apna Apna, older films are returning to the screens as audiences like Kapur Alva revisit old classics, even if it's on a streaming platform. Cinemas are only too happy to oblige, allotting yesteryear films screens as well as shows.

» SECOND CHANCES

Re-releasing films is now an integral part of PVR INOX Ltd's programming. And driving their decision is not "nostalgia showcasing" or "filling in lean weekends", says their lead strategist Niharika Bijli, but the "diverse" audience you cannot overlook. "There's the nostalgia audience who wants to experience a film with someone new," she elaborates. "Then there are those who want a taste of what you can experience at home on the big screen for the first time. Finally, there are the cinephile fans of an actor or director and the curious young, college-going audience who want to understand why a certain title is a cult film." The multiplex giant relies on customer feedback on ground and on social media to identify the titles to re-release. It recently hosted a Kareena Kapoor Khan film festival across 10-15 cities with a release of some of her most-beloved performances after the actor completed 25 years in Bollywood.

Celebrating anniversaries, like *Wake Up Sid*'s 15th in October, is just one way to position re-releases. Some just want a second shot at success. Like *Tumbbad*, which with footfalls of nearly 2.5 million and a run of over two months in cinemas, collected Rs 36.5 crore after releasing in multiplexes as well as single-screen cinemas. That's more than what *Laapataa Ladies* did in its theatrical run early this year. "What happened with *Tumbbad* is extraordinary," says Bijli. "They cut their own trailer, brought out a new poster and marketing material. It benefitted the business."

Sohum Shah beams hearing the praise. When *Tumbbad* failed to make a dent at the box office in October 2018, facing competition first from *Andhadhun* and then *Badhaai Ho*, Shah knew his labour of love, to which he devoted six years, deserved better. "People were not aware," he says. "We didn't have big stars or songs, only content." In August, Shah approached PVR INOX to re-release it, certain there was an audience for it. He implemented what he calls "passion-driven marketing" and added a slate at *Tumbbad*'s end, announcing a part II. "We played on the front foot, *joh tab nahin hua tha, woh ab hoga* [what didn't happen then will happen now]," he says. After making Rs



↑ REHNAA HAI TERRE DIL MEIN

Original release: **2001**

Bombay Jayashri's mellifluously rendered 'Zara Zara' continues to have hearts racing. The film it was featured in has its share of fans who returned to the cinemas to help it mint another Rs 3.25 crore



→ LAILA MAJNU

Original release: **2018**

It took four days for the film to cross its initial collection of Rs 2.15 crore. The Triptii Dimri-starrer earned Rs 11.2 crore, exceeding the film's Rs 10 crore budget and becoming a hit